

National Aeronautics and Space Administration

Goddard Space Flight Center
Greenbelt, MD 20771



September 5, 2026

Reply to Attn of: 171

TO: All Potential Offerors

SUBJECT: Draft Request for Proposal (DRFP), Solicitation No. 80GSFC25R7005, for the
Sounder for Microwave-Based Applications Solicitation, Amendment 13 Update

You are invited to review and comment on the National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA) Goddard Space Flight Center's (GSFC) Sounder for Microwave-Based Applications (SMBA) solicitation. The principal purpose of this requirement is to design, develop, and support the SMBA instruments under the Near Earth Orbit Network (NEON) program.

Potential offerors are encouraged to comment on all aspects of the draft solicitation, including the contract structure, requirements, deliverables, schedules, proposal instructions, evaluation approaches, and any perceived safety, occupational health, security (including information technology security), environmental, export control, and/or other programmatic risk issues associated with performance of the work. Potential offerors should identify any perceived unnecessary, inefficient, or otherwise concerning requirements as well as any perceived beneficial requirements. The requirements include, but are not limited to, the Statement of Work, Contract Data Requirements List, and Performance Requirements Document. Potential offerors are also encouraged to comment on the requirements' overall alignment with the Instrument's intended risk approach.

Potential offerors are encouraged to comment on the early funding profile and what risks, if any, funding available poses to the technical requirements, cost, and schedule on contract.

	<u>GFY 2027</u>	<u>GFY 2028</u>	<u>GFY 2029</u>
Non-Recurring Engineering	\$19M	\$40M	\$40M
Long Lead Items	\$30M	\$0M	\$0M
Note: The funding profile above represents the anticipated funding for each selected offeror.			

NASA will conduct this acquisition as a full and open competition and intends to implement the following contract architecture. The final contract clauses will take precedence over any statements below:

1. Multi-phase, Multi-Select Acquisition – This acquisition will be conducted in two phases. Phase 1 will award contracts to up to two contractors, after which a competitive down-select process will choose one contractor to proceed with Phase 2. **This source selection will choose the Phase 1 contractor(s) only.**
2. Phase 1
 - a. Number of contractors: Up to two contractors
 - b. Period of Performance: Contract Effective Date through Engineering Test Unit (ETU) Summary Review Package Completion
 - c. Scope: Includes Long Lead Items for Flight Models 1-4; ETU; and all associated reviews through the ETU Summary Review Package
 - d. Contract Type: Long Lead Items for Flight Models 1-4 will be Firm Fixed Price, Task Orders will be Time and Materials, and the remaining scope will be Cost Plus Fixed Fee
3. Down-Select for Phase 2
 - a. Solicitation: Occurs through separate Letter Request for Proposal
 - b. Point in time: Occurs at approximately Phase 1 contract authorization to proceed plus 18 months
 - c. Evaluation Criteria: Critical Design Review package, ETU test data, forward plans, and other related items. However, these evaluation factors are not final and can change up to the date of the Phase 2 Letter Request for Proposal
4. Phase 2
 - a. Number of contractors: One contractor
 - b. Period of Performance: End of Phase 1 through Final SMBA Flight Model Launch Plus 18 Months
 - c. Scope: Design, analyze, develop, fabricate, integrate, test, evaluate, and support launch of up to eight SMBA instruments (four units plus an option for four additional units); supply and maintain the instrument Ground Support Equipment; and support the Mission Operations at the mission operations facility
 - d. Contract Type: Firm Fixed Price
5. Task Order Mechanism
 - a. Period of Performance: Spans both Phase 1 and Phase 2 (if awarded)
 - b. Scope: Special Studies and Post Launch Support
 - c. Contract Type: Time and Materials

The North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) code for this acquisition is 334511, Search, Detection, Navigation, Guidance, Aeronautical, and Nautical System and Instrument Manufacturing with a small business size standard of 1,350 employees.

Potential offerors should ensure its company is listed in the online database(s) for the following:

- (1) System for award management: <https://www.sam.gov>
- (2) U.S. Department of Labor Veterans' Employment and Training Service, VETS-4212 Reports: <https://vets4212.dol.gov/vets4212/>
- (3) US Government's unique entity identifier (UEI): <https://www.gsa.gov/about-us/organization/federal-acquisition-service/technology-transformation-services/integrated-award-environment-iae/iae-systems-information-kit/unique-entity-identifier-update>

The current planned release date for the Final Request for Proposal (RFP) is the first quarter of 2026, with proposals being due approximately 30 calendar days later.

The anticipated contract award date and effective date is in the second quarter of 2027. The contract will be performed primarily at the Contractor's facilities with performance at Subcontractor facilities, Spacecraft contractor facilities, and Mission Operations Centers.

The following additional information is provided to assist in understanding this acquisition:

1. The Government will make available specific Government Furnished Property (GFP) for offsite use at the Contractor's facility as described in the DRFP.
2. NASA has determined that this acquisition may give rise to a potential organizational conflict of interest (OCI). Offerors should refer to the contract: Section I, clause 1852.237-72 ACCESS TO SENSITIVE INFORMATION; Section L, provision NOTICE OF POTENTIAL ORGANIZATIONAL CONFLICTS OF INTEREST; and Section L, provision PROSPECTIVE CONTRACTOR RESPONSIBILITY AND ELIGIBILITY STANDARDS.
3. Proposals for this solicitation are required to be submitted through NASA's Enterprise File Sharing and Sync Box (EFSS Box), a FedRAMP Moderate certified platform. Potential offerors, especially those that have not previously submitted a proposal utilizing NASA's EFSS Box, are encouraged to review the solicitation instruction entitled "Electronic Submission of Proposals – Proposal Marking and Delivery Through NASA's EFSS Box" which provides instructions related to the submission of proposal via EFSS Box. Offerors are encouraged to check with their corporate IT staff to determine if there are firewall restrictions that would need to be addressed prior to the submission of proposal files through NASA's EFSS Box.

In order to control and protect sensitive data owned by the Government and its Contractors, NASA policy requires all acquisition-related documents be released in Adobe Portable Document Format (PDF) with the exception of the Cost Exhibits (RFP Enclosure 2).

Documents related to this acquisition, including this letter, the solicitation, attachments, exhibits, any amendments and links to online reference/technical/bidders library will be attainable

electronically from the World Wide Web through the Government-wide point of entry website at www.SAM.gov. Potential Offerors are requested to periodically monitor the websites for updates.

NASA FAR Supplement (NFS) clause 1852.215-84, OMBUDSMAN, is applicable. The Ombudsman for this acquisition is Raymond Rubilotta, Raymond.J.Rubilotta@nasa.gov, 301-286-5867.

This DRFP is not a solicitation and NASA is not requesting proposals. This DRFP does not commit NASA GSFC to pay any proposal preparation costs, nor does it obligate NASA GSFC to procure or contract for this requirement. This request is not an authorization to proceed, and does not authorize payment for any charges incurred by the offeror for performing any of the work called for in this solicitation.

Any comments regarding the DRFP should be submitted electronically in writing to Bruce Tsai, Contracting Officer, at Bruce.B.Tsai@nasa.gov, within the date specified in Government Point of Entry (GPE), <https://www.sam.gov>. If a respondent believes their comments contain confidential, proprietary, competition sensitive, or business information, those questions/comments shall be marked appropriately. However, questions that are marked as containing confidential, proprietary, competition sensitive or business information will not be provided a Government response. The Government will consider all comments received in preparation of the Final RFP. To the extent a comment leads the Government to revise the acquisition approach or requirements, the change will be reflected in the Final RFP. Some DRFP questions and comments may receive a posted response to the GPE if the Contracting Officer determines that a response would facilitate additional understanding of the solicitation. The Government may also respond via the GPE to comments and/or questions received following the issuance of the Final RFP.

Bruce Tsai
Contracting Officer

Enclosure:

Draft RFP 80GSFC25R7005, Amendment 13